

How to use this book

This book starts with guidance on how to enjoy a healthy and safe pregnancy, with lifestyle advice that often applies to the preconceptual period too. The core section of the book gives a day-by-day account of pregnancy with detailed explanations of the physical and emotional changes that take place in your body along with fascinating insights into how your baby develops within the uterus. A labor and birth chapter takes you through the delivery of your baby, followed by a summary of the first two weeks with your newborn. A final chapter deals with concerns and complications in the mother and baby in pregnancy, labor, and the postpartum period.

A healthy pregnancy

This chapter provides the information you need to make lifestyle choices that will maximize your own health throughout pregnancy and give your baby the best possible start in life. It includes guidelines for exercising safely, eating healthily, avoiding hazards, and dealing with illnesses. It also addresses concerns you may have about how the emotional and physical changes of pregnancy may impact your relationships.



Learn simple ways to relax and tune in to your body. As well as being essential to your physical and mental well-being, exercise or physical activity will help you prepare for labor and birth.

Pregnancy day by day

Here, the book takes you day by day through the extraordinary story of conception and pregnancy, counting down each of the 280 days until the onset of labor. Each day